

Worksheet 1: Mapping My Obsessions and Compulsions

Name: _____ Date: _____ Clinician: _____

This worksheet helps map out exactly what the unwanted thoughts are, what sets them off, and what you do when they show up. There are no right or wrong answers - we are gathering information so we can build a plan together. Remember: having an intrusive thought is not the same as wanting it, meaning it, or acting on it. Intrusive thoughts are common; OCD is about the meaning we give them and the reactions we do.

If completing this brings up strong distress, or any thoughts of harming yourself, pause and tell your clinician or use your safety plan / a crisis line. This can be filled in together in session.

A. The intrusive thoughts / images / urges (obsessions)

Write the unwanted thoughts, images, or urges that keep coming even though you do not want them.

How often do they come? (circle) many times a day / a few times a day / most days / now and then

When are they strongest? e.g. certain places, times, objects, feelings, when alone ...

B. What sets them off (triggers)

Triggers are situations, objects, places, thoughts, or feelings that make the obsession more likely. Rate how much distress each brings, from 0 (none) to 100 (worst imaginable).

Trigger (situation / object / thought / feeling)	SUDS (0-100)	Notes

C. What the obsession makes me believe

When the thought comes, what does it seem to mean about you or what might happen? (e.g. "it means I am dangerous / responsible / a bad person", "something terrible will happen").

How much do I believe that (0-100%)? _____

D. What I do about it (compulsions - including hidden ones)

Compulsions are anything you do to reduce the distress or 'make sure' - including mental acts nobody can see. They feel like they help, but they keep the obsession going. Tick what applies and add your own.

Reaction I do when the obsession hits	Do I do this? (Y/N)	How often
Try to push away / suppress / block the thought		
Seek reassurance (from others or myself)		
Avoid the trigger / people / places / objects		
Check (physically or mentally)		
Wash / clean / repeat / arrange		
Mentally review, pray, count, or 'cancel out'		
Replace the thought with a 'safe' thought		

E. My OCD cycle

1. Trigger: _____

2. Obsession (thought/image/urge): _____

3. Feeling + body sensations: _____

4. Compulsion / avoidance I do: _____

5. Short-term relief, then: the obsession returns, often stronger

The goal of therapy is to break this cycle at step 4 - learning to allow the thought to be there without doing the reaction, so the brain learns it is not a real threat.